

Quality Food Production

Science

May, 2026

Quality Food Production (A13163)

Short Title: Quality Food Production
Faculty Science and Computing
Department Science
Cluster Food Science
Author ICASEY
Credits 5

Level: Intermediate

Description of Module / Aims

This module will enable the student to have a comprehensive understanding of the issues related to farm food safety, and quality issues relevant to the modern food chain.

Programmes

FDSC-0006 BSc in Agriculture (WD_SAGUL_D)

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Indicative Content

- Introduction to the food chain
- Quality assurance principles and hazard analysis principles
- Animal feed safety, quality and traceability
- Animal medicines
- Pathogens and biosecurity
- Animal welfare
- Hygiene
- Crops and horticultural produce
- Food quality

Learning Outcomes

On successful completion of this module, a student will be able to:

1. Analyse the modern food chain.
2. Analyse the issues related to farm food safety and quality.
3. Complete a hazard analysis approach to farm food production.
4. Determine the important hazards and compliance requirements for feeds and medicines.
5. Explore the issues relating to pathogens and biosecurity risks.
6. Prepare a report addressing the key animal welfare issues and all requirements of the Bord Bia Scheme.
7. Debate the quality and food safety issues relating to field crops and horticultural produce.

Learning and Teaching Methods

- Lectures.
- Tutorials.
- Site visits.

Assessment Methods

	Weighing	Outcomes Assessed
Final Written Examination	60%	1,2,4,7
Continuous Assessment	40%	
<i>Assignment</i>	30%	6
<i>Project</i>	10%	5,3

Assessment Criteria

<40%: Very limited knowledge and understanding of the subject matter.

40%-49%: Demonstrate a limited knowledge of the subject matter.

50%-59%: Demonstrate satisfactory general knowledge of the main issues within the subject.

60%-69%: Demonstrate sound knowledge of the subject matter. Show ability to analyse and logically argue in an effective and mature style.

70%-100%: Demonstrate authoritative handling of complex material and a highly developed and extensive understanding of the subject. Provide well focused analysis and convincing argument on the subject.

Learning Modes

Learning Mode	F/T Hours	P/T Hours
Lecture	36	
Field Trips	12	
Independent Learning	87	

Essential Material

- Bord Bia , N.A. *_Beef Quality Assurance Scheme Technical Manual_*. Ireland: Bord Bia, 2015.
- Department of Agriculture, N.A. *_The Safe Food Chain_*. Ireland: DAFF, 2001.
- FSAI, N.A. *_Food Safety and Genetically Modified Foods_*. Ireland: FSAI, 2014.
- FSAI, N.A. *_Labelling of Foods in Ireland_*. Ireland: FSAI, 2002.

Supplementary Material

- Bord Bia , N.A. *_Lamb Quality Assurance Scheme_*. Ireland : Bord Bia, 2015.
- Bord Bia , N.A. *_Pigmeat Quality Assurance Scheme_*. Ireland: Bord Bia, 2015.